

CASE ID: 202103710020

EPISODE NAME: China Retaliates Following Xinjiang Sanctions (Canada)

2021/03/27 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: Canada (20)

Issue: Retaliation (16)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Summary:

On 2021/03/27, China imposed travel bans and business activity restrictions on Canada after the country sanctioned China over human rights abuses in Xinjiang on 2021/03/22. This episode is ongoing.

Narrative:

After Canada imposed sanctions on four Xinjiang senior officials and one entity in coordination with the United States, European Union, and United Kingdom on 2021/03/22, the China imposed sanctions on Canada on 2021/03/27.¹² The Ministry of Foreign Affairs announced that the sanctions entailed travel bans and business activity restrictions on Member of Parliament Michael Chong and the Canadian Subcommittee on International Human Rights.³

The episode is part of a larger campaign of economic coercion that escalated on 2024/12/11, when Canada sanctioned additional Chinese officials over human rights abuses in Xinjiang, to which China retaliated.⁴⁵

The sanctions are still in place, and this episode is ongoing as of 2025/12/31.

¹ "Canada joins international partners in imposing new sanctions in response to human rights violations in Xinjiang." Global Affairs Canada, 22 March 2021. <https://www.canada.ca/en/global-affairs/news/2021/03/canada-joins-international-partners-in-imposing-new-sanctions-in-response-to-human-rights-violations-in-xinjiang.html>

² "Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Announces Sanctions on Relevant US and Canadian Individuals and Entity." Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the People's Republic of China, 27 March 2021. https://www.mfa.gov.cn/eng/xw/fyrbt/fyrbt/202405/t20240530_11349692.html

³ Ibid.

⁴ "Canada sanctions 8 Chinese officials, citing human rights violations." *Reuters*, 11 Dec. 2024. <https://www.reuters.com/world/canada-sanctions-8-chinese-officials-citing-human-rights-violations-2024-12-10/>

⁵ "China takes steps against Canada institutions, individuals over Uyghurs, Tibet." *Reuters*, 23 Dec. 2024. <https://www.reuters.com/world/china-take-steps-against-canada-institutions-individuals-over-uyghurs-tibet-2024-12-22/>